



▲ Into the light

This quilted mural, entitled "Into the Light" depicts Harriet Tubman leading escaped slaves to freedom on the Underground Railroad (see left).

**"SELF-RELIANCE
IS THE TRUE
ROAD TO
INDEPENDENCE."**

MARY ANN SHADD CARY, MOTTO OF HER NEWSPAPER,
PROVINCIAL FREEMAN, FOUNDED IN 1853



◀ Free at last

A former slave poses with two men of the so-called Abolition Regiment who have escorted her to freedom, via the Underground Railroad. For women, escaping was particularly difficult as they had fewer opportunities and often had children to take care of.

the cotton-producing states of the Deep South held on to protect its plantation economy.

As the abolitionist movement gained momentum, women played a prominent role. Black women such as Sojourner Truth (see pp. 174–175), Harriet Tubman, and Mary Ann Shadd Cary toured the US giving impassioned speeches that described the horrors and hypocrisy of slavery. Learning of the struggles of black mothers searching for their families inspired empathy in some white Americans, and convinced women such as novelist Harriet Beecher Stowe to take up the cause. Still, full emancipation in the US did not come until 1865, after a bloody Civil War (see pp. 176–177). In 1888, Brazil made slavery illegal, which many regard as the end of the transatlantic slave trade.

